

Finago Tech Lead Case — Audit Log

What we're looking for

This is a take-home case for our Tech Lead hiring process. We are more interested in **how you think, decide and communicate** than in code volume.

You will not finish everything in the time budget — that is intentional.

Time and scope

Budget **3–6 hours of focused work**. We will not reward over-investment.

Scope down, note what you chose to defer, and tell us why. A clean, working, well-thought-through slice beats a sprawling half-broken one.

On using AI

Use AI tools the way you would in your day job. We just ask: every line is yours to defend, every architectural decision is yours to own, and you should be able to discuss any part of your submission in detail. There is no benefit to hiding AI usage; there is a real cost to code you cannot speak to.

The problem

We want an **audit log service** that any team at Finago Office could plug into.

The people who will read these logs include:

- An accountant in Helsinki, in Finnish, looking at what her newly hired bookkeeper did last week.
- Her colleague in Stockholm, reading the same firm's logs in Swedish.
- An auditor in Oslo, six months later, in Norwegian, building a regulatory case.
- A Finago support engineer in Kuala Lumpur at 03:00 local time, in English, trying to figure out why an order disappeared.
- Eventually, a Nordic data subject exercising their GDPR rights — and a regulator checking that we honoured them.

Events come from services that may sit in different regions and produce events at different rates. Some user actions are simple ("user updated an order"). Others are not — an admin clicking "deactivate employee" might revoke sessions, cancel pending payroll, and update the user record in one go. New event types will be added by other teams later, without notice.

That's the domain. Decide what matters, decide what doesn't, build a slice that holds up.

What to build

1. **Code.** A schema (as migrations or ORM models) backed by a database, plus one or two working API endpoints — at minimum, ingestion and query — with seed data showing the system in action. README under one page.
2. **A decisions log.** Two or three short ADRs covering the choices you'd defend in design review: context, decision, alternatives you rejected and why, consequences. We genuinely care about the rejected alternatives.
3. **A short writeup/presentation.** How does this scale? How would you get other Finago Office teams to adopt it without each one reinventing it? Anything else you'd want to say standing at a whiteboard but didn't have time to build.
4. **A frontend view (optional).** If you want to render the logs in a small UI on top of your API, do so. If you'd rather spend that time on the writeup, do that instead.

Stack

Use whatever stack you're most comfortable with — we will read the code either way. For context, Finago Office runs **Node.js + TypeScript** and **C# .NET** on the backend, **React** on the frontend, **MSSQL/MariaDB/Cassandra/DynamoDB/PostgreSQL**, and deploys to **Kubernetes** in our local cloud provider, **AWS Lambda, ECS**, and other container hosting. Pick from this list or use something else entirely.

Be prepared to walk us through the documentation, code and decision log on your interview.